

Bilawal Ali

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Professional Summary

Final-year Cyber Security student and SOC Analyst (L1) intern with hands-on experience in SIEM monitoring, alert triage, and incident response across Wazuh, Splunk, and the ELK Stack. Skilled at mapping real-world incidents – brute-force logins, lateral movement, unauthorized file changes, phishing – to MITRE ATT&CK and driving them through to escalation.

Technical Skills

SIEM & Log Analysis: Wazuh, Splunk, ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana), Log Correlation, Alert Triage
Threat Detection & IR: Incident Response, IOC Analysis, Threat Hunting, Alert Escalation, File Integrity Monitoring (FIM)
Frameworks: MITRE ATT&CK, NIST SP 800-61, Cyber Kill Chain, OWASP Top 10
Network Security: Suricata IDS, pfSense, Squid Proxy, Wireshark, TCP/IP, Network Traffic Analysis
Offensive Security Tools: Nmap, Burp Suite, Metasploit, SQLmap, Hydra, Ncrack
Forensics & Malware Analysis: Volatility, Autopsy, REMnux, FLARE-VM, YARA
Programming & Automation: Python (Pandas, Scapy, Flask), Bash Scripting
Operating Systems: Windows, Linux (Ubuntu/Debian), Kali Linux

Professional Experience

SOC Analyst Intern (L1)

Cyberster

Remote

- Monitored and triaged 1,000+ daily security events in Wazuh SIEM, cutting mean time to detect (MTTD) through systematic alert prioritization.
- Investigated brute-force logins, authentication anomalies, and lateral movement across Linux and Windows endpoints; wrote 5+ custom Wazuh detection rules for previously unmonitored attack vectors.
- Configured File Integrity Monitoring (FIM) and Active Response to catch unauthorized changes and auto-block malicious IPs, cutting manual remediation workload.
- Mapped alerts to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques; authored structured incident reports following SOC escalation procedures.

Red Team Intern

ITSOLERA Pvt Ltd

June 2024 – August 2024

Remote

- Executed 20+ vulnerability assessments and penetration tests (VAPT) against web applications using industry-standard methodologies.
- Identified and documented high-risk vulnerabilities including SQL Injection, XSS, CSRF, and broken authentication; delivered formal client reports.
- Leveraged Burp Suite for HTTP traffic interception and analysis; used Metasploit for controlled post-exploitation and privilege-escalation testing.

Independent Bug Hunter

Security Researcher

January 2024 – Present

- Conducted 10+ independent vulnerability assessments across public web applications and APIs; responsibly disclosed findings to affected organizations.
- Discovered SQL Injection, XSS, and access-control flaws through manual testing with Burp Suite and custom scripts.

Projects

SOC & Threat Simulation Lab (Splunk, Wazuh, ELK)

- Deployed and configured Splunk, Wazuh, and ELK Stack on a local lab environment for centralized log collection and analysis.
- Integrated endpoints, firewalls (pfSense), and IDS (Suricata) to simulate real SOC data sources.
- Simulated attacks including SSH brute-force and malware payloads to validate detection rules; developed incident response playbooks aligned with NIST SP 800-61.

AI-Based PDF Malware Detection & Forensic Analysis

Mehran University (MUET)

- Built a machine learning-based malware detection system trained on 10,000+ benign and malicious PDF samples, achieving high classification accuracy.

- Integrated Explainable AI (SHAP) to surface feature importance, enabling analyst-interpretable model decisions – directly applicable to SOC triage workflows.

MailForensics – DFIR Email Analysis Platform

- Developed a Python/Streamlit forensic tool for SOC and DFIR teams to parse .eml files, extract IOCs (spoofed domains, malicious URLs), and detect phishing indicators.

Certifications

- Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH – PFTP) | Medal & Certificate Awarded
- Professional Offensive Operations – Hack The Box (Pro Lab)
- Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate
- Intro to Splunk (eLearning) – Splunk (2026)
- Junior Cybersecurity Analyst Career Path – Cisco Networking Academy
- Endpoint Security – Cisco Networking Academy
- Introduction to Cybersecurity – Cisco Networking Academy
- Networking Basics – Cisco Networking Academy
- OPSWAT Cybersecurity Fundamentals Associate
- Ethical Hacking Essentials – EC-Council

Achievements

- **QUEST CTF 2026 – 1st Place:** Secured top ranking in a competitive university-level Capture The Flag cybersecurity competition.
- **NADRA Bug Bounty Challenge 2026 – Consolation Prize (Team Lead):** Led a team in a national-level bug bounty program organized by Pakistan’s National Database and Registration Authority; identified and responsibly reported live vulnerabilities.
- **Ignite CTF Hackathon:** Ranked 29th nationally with Muet Cyber Squad in a real-world cybersecurity challenge.
- **Hands-On Platforms:** 150+ labs on PortSwigger Web Security Academy; active on Hack The Box and TryHackMe (SOC, Blue Team, and Red Team paths).

Leadership, Community & Volunteering

Lead – ACCESS~DENIED

MUET Cyber Security Department

August 2026

Jamshoro, Pakistan

- Led ACCESS~DENIED in creating and organizing the BSCYS CTF Hackathon 2026 and BSCYS Quiz Competition 2026, promoting practical cybersecurity learning and analytical problem-solving.
- Directed the design of hands-on CTF challenges across OSINT, Forensics, Reverse Engineering, Cryptography, Networking, and Steganography.

Cybersecurity Guest Speaker

MUET Cyber Security Society

2026

Jamshoro, Pakistan

- Delivered a cybersecurity session for the 25th Batch BSc Cyber Security students, sharing practical cybersecurity knowledge and encouraging hands-on learning.

Cybersecurity Event Volunteer

MUET Cyber Security Community

2026

Jamshoro, Pakistan

- Supported the organization and execution of cybersecurity competitions and student-focused technical activities, contributing to participant coordination and event operations.

Education

Mehran University of Engineering & Technology (MUET)

Bachelor of Science in Cyber Security

Jamshoro, Pakistan

CGPA: 3.31 / 4.0

Languages & Soft Skills

Languages: English (Professional Proficiency) | Urdu (Fluent) | Sindhi (Native)

Soft Skills: Analytical Thinking | Incident Documentation | Problem Solving | Team Collaboration | Leadership | Time Management | Attention to Detail | Communication